

Charlie Foster, LHP, Ole Miss

2026 Stats: 6.69 ERA/36.1 IP/1.651 WHIP/37 K/22 BB/1.68 K:BB

6-4, 205

Metrics

FB: 93.7/19.4 IVB/-4.7 HB/-5.08 VAA/5.9 ext/6.6 relH/38% zone/47.2 AA/50.8% usage/2270 rpm

CT: 89.2/7.8 IVB/3 HB/-6.79 VAA/44.6% zone/45.4 AA/15.6% usage/2500 rpm

CB: 78.3/-13.1 IVB/5.3 HB/-10.15 VAA/41.9% zone/47.6 AA/10.5% usage/2530 rpm

CH: 87.1/6.2 IVB/-12.1 HB/-7.82 VAA/27.9% zone/47.1 AA/23.1% usage/1230 rpm

Write-up

Foster is a tall lefty with big arm-swing into a high arm angle/release combo. A four pitch mix, highlighted by a fading split-change and riding FB that create steep angles to the plate. A slight cross fire exacerbates this angles game as he gets big horizontal angle on the FB. He struggled out of the pen at Mississippi State in 2026 and transferred across the state to Ole Miss for his draft season. He flipfopped between the rotation and long relief through the year and his best role long term might be a high leverage lefty that can get 6 outs. He struggled to put guys away and walked a few more guys than you'd like for a starter and the frame is relatively maxed out. He's not that fluid of a mover either, limiting the upside as well. There is a plus reliever in here that can get righties out, but refining command will be important to succeed at the next level.

The FB plays as an angle-driven offering with true ride and the ability to create whiffs at the top of the zone. The steep approach angle allows it to miss bats when elevated, particularly up and away to right-handed hitters. Command consistency is the primary limiter. Too many misses leaked into the middle of the zone, leading to damage despite solid underlying traits. Left-handed hitters were able to square the pitch when it leaked over the plate, though overall outcomes were moderated by the release angle and vertical approach. The pitch would benefit from more consistent elevation usage and reduced middle-zone exposure. 45/50 pitch

The cutter plays with steep vertical action and functions more as a depth-based cutter than a true horizontal mover. It generated consistent swing rates but below-average contact suppression due to location inconsistency. The pitch was frequently left in the heart of the zone rather than executed down and glove-side, which limited its effectiveness as a bat-missing or contact-management pitch. When located properly, it showed the ability to get in on right-handed hitters and produce weak contact. Refinement of shape consistency and improved glove-side command would allow the pitch to play more consistently above-average. 45/50+ pitch

The CB is a true 12–6 style breaking ball with steep depth and solid bat-missing traits when executed. The pitch generated swing-and-miss primarily when located beneath the zone and showed the ability to freeze hitters when started in competitive counts. The main limitation is consistency in executing depth. When left elevated, it loses effectiveness quickly, but when properly buried it flashes above-average miss traits. Continued improvement in consistent below-zone execution would elevate the pitch into a more reliable putaway option. 40/45+ pitch

The changeup is the best pitch in the arsenal and the foundation of Foster's profile. It features strong velocity separation with plus vertical action and some arm-side run, playing off his high release point effectively. The pitch generated strong chase and whiff rates against right-handed hitters and consistently produced ground balls with weak contact outcomes. Command to the arm-side bottom of the zone was a clear strength, allowing him to steal strikes and finish at-bats efficiently. Usage was heavily platoon-dependent, with limited deployment against left-handed hitters. Expanding usage and maintaining consistent down-zone execution against both sides would significantly increase its value and could be the key driver of a rotation outcome. 50/60+ pitch